



TAKE A STAND

Consumers in the developed world can push businesses to do the right thing through boycotts. In 2013, the Rana Plaza clothing factory in Bangladesh collapsed, killing over 1,100 people. The clothing chains Primark and Benetton, supplied by the factory, faced protests. Since then, there's been pressure for clothing retailers to ensure safety in the factories where their garments are made, and to give details of where their goods come from.



FAIR TRADE

The Fair trade movement began in the 1990s to prevent coffee and banana growers in poor countries from losing out because of low market prices. Fair-trade organizations guarantee suppliers a fair price. In return, suppliers ensure workers are properly paid and employed. Consumers support this by buying Fair-trade certified goods. This works when prices are low, but when prices rise suppliers lose out.



EXPLOITED WORKERS

To stay competitive, businesses cut costs, and may turn a blind eye to the conditions of workers making goods for them. In recent years, consumers in the developed world have become aware that many of the goods they purchase so cheaply in stores, such as clothing and electrical goods, are produced in less developed countries—in factories where safety is neglected, in sweatshops, and by child or even slave labor. This has forced businesses to change their production procedures and be more transparent about them.